

Chapter 3

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet: Building Effective Communication Skills

Complete the activities below to practice and reflect on your communication skills. Keep your answers brief and focused. This worksheet is designed to be engaging and practical, with minimal long written responses. If you need extra space, use the back of the sheet or a separate page.

Part 1: Speaking Clearly and Confidently (10-15 minutes) Activity: Quick Speech Check

- Pick a simple topic (e.g., your favorite hobby or a recent school event).
- Speak about it for 1 minute while recording yourself on your phone or having a friend listen.
- Count how many filler words ("um," "like," "you know") you use. Write the number here: _____
- Try again, focusing on pausing silently instead of using fillers. Write the new number here: _____
- **Reflection (1-2 sentences):** Did pausing help reduce fillers? How did your confidence feel the second time?

Part 2: Active Listening in Conversations (10 minutes) Activity: Listening Focus Challenge

- Pair up with a classmate, friend, or family member.
- Listen to them talk about their day or a favorite activity for 1-2 minutes. Focus on not interrupting and showing engagement (nodding, eye contact).
- After they finish, summarize their main point in 1 sentence. Write it here: _____
- Ask one follow-up question based on what they said. Write it here: _____
- **Reflection (1-2 sentences):** Was it hard to avoid interrupting? How did they react to your follow-up question?

Part 3: Handling Awkward or Tough Questions (10-15 minutes) Activity: Quick Response Practice

- Below are two tough questions often asked in interviews. Write a short response (2-3 sentences) for each, focusing on staying calm and positive. Practice saying your answers out loud to a partner or in front of a mirror.
 - **Question:** What is your biggest weakness? **Response:** _____
 - **Question:** Tell me about a time you failed at something. **Response:** _____
- **Reflection (1-2 sentences):** Did practicing out loud make you feel more prepared? What would you change in your answers?

Part 4: Quick Self-Assessment (5 minutes) Activity: Rate Yourself

- On a scale of 1 (needs improvement) to 5 (very strong), rate your current skills in each area after completing this worksheet. Circle your rating.
 - Speaking Clearly and Confidently: 1 2 3 4 5

- Active Listening: 1 2 3 4 5
- Handling Tough Questions: 1 2 3 4 5

- **Goal Setting (1 sentence):** Pick one area to improve this week. What will you do to work on it?

Bonus Challenge (Optional, 5-10 minutes)

- Over the next 3 days, notice one real-life moment where you used a skill from this chapter (e.g., reducing fillers in class, listening during a convo, or answering a hard question). Jot down the moment and how it went in 1-2 sentences. **Moment:**

How It Went: